

Agentic AI — Executive Brief for Kore.ai Leadership

(Wednesday, 24 June 2026)

Bottom line: Five9's recent product launches and ongoing struggles with its seat-based model highlight significant opportunities for Kore.ai to position itself as the more reliable and cost-effective solution for enterprise customers.

Executive summary

1. Five9's introduction of new AI agents and voice capabilities underscores its attempt to pivot towards agentic AI, but its reliance on a traditional seat-based pricing model exposes it to cost unpredictability, creating a clear undercut opportunity for Kore.ai.
2. Sierra's rapid growth and high valuation are not matched by independent analyst validation, revealing a gap that Kore.ai can exploit by emphasizing its established leadership in analyst rankings and comprehensive enterprise solutions.
3. Cresta's recent showcase of AI capabilities at a major conference signals its competitive positioning; however, its complexity in pricing and build processes presents vulnerabilities that Kore.ai can address through clearer value propositions and simpler integrations.

Five9's New AI Agents Highlight Cost Uncertainty in Seat-Based Models

- (2026-06-24) **Five9 Launches Breakthrough New Release of Voice AI Agents to Power the Next Generation of Agentic Self Service:** The new AI agents aim to enhance customer interactions but remain tethered to a seat-based pricing model, which can lead to unpredictable costs as automation scales. Kore.ai can capitalize on this by promoting its outcome-based pricing model, which offers more predictable TCO. [Business Wire](#)

Sierra's Analyst Validation Gap Contrasts with Its Hype

- (2026-06-24) **Forbes 2026 AI 50 List | Top Artificial Intelligence Companies:** While Sierra is gaining attention and funding, it lacks recognition as a leader in key analyst evaluations for customer experience, which Kore.ai can leverage to position itself as the more validated choice for enterprise clients. [Forbes](#)

Cresta's Complexity in Pricing and Build Processes Leaves Room for Kore.ai

- (2026-06-24) **Cresta Showcases AI Customer Experience Capabilities at CCW Las Vegas:** Cresta's focus on showcasing its capabilities may overshadow the complexity and cost of its offerings, which Kore.ai can address by emphasizing its simpler integration and transparent pricing strategies. [TipRanks](#)

Recommended actions for Kore.ai

- **Sales:** Develop targeted messaging that emphasizes the predictability and reliability of Kore.ai's pricing model compared to Five9's seat-based model, especially for enterprise clients concerned about TCO.
- **Product Marketing:** Create case studies highlighting Kore.ai's leadership in analyst evaluations, contrasting it with Sierra's lack of validation to strengthen market positioning.

- **Analyst Relations:** Engage with analysts to reinforce Kore.ai's strong standing in the market and ensure continued recognition as a leader in the conversational AI space.
- **Product:** Consider enhancements to the integration process to simplify onboarding and usage, addressing the complexity highlighted by competitors like Cresta.

Appendix — sources

- (2026-06-24) Five9 Launches Breakthrough New Release of Voice AI Agents to Power the Next Generation of Agentic Self Service - Business Wire — [Link](#)
- (2026-06-24) Forbes 2026 AI 50 List | Top Artificial Intelligence Companies - Forbes — [Link](#)
- (2026-06-24) Cresta Showcases AI Customer Experience Capabilities at CCW Las Vegas - TipRanks — [Link](#)